

THE BAKING EXPERIENCE PRESENTS

AQUAFABA

&

EGG REPLACERS

A field guide to the bean water that changed everything.

— THE —  —
BAKING EXPERIENCE

BEAN WATER.



(The fancy kind.)

aqua (water) + **faba** (bean) · Named in 2015 ·
Crowdsourced from a Facebook vegan group

The liquid from cooking chickpeas — that slightly viscous brine you usually pour down the drain.

Proteins + starches + saponins

Natural surfactants from the chickpeas give it foam, emulsification, and binding properties.

It whips.

The only egg replacer that actually forms stiff peaks. Nothing else comes close.

~3-5 calories per 2 tbsp

Nutritionally negligible. It's here for structure, not sustenance.

Why did it take so long?

Bean cooking liquid was just considered waste. Once someone tried whipping it, the logic became obvious.



WHAT IS IT?

The liquid from cooking chickpeas that most people pour down the drain.

Proteins + starches
+ saponins =
natural magic.

Where does your aquafaba come from?



CANNED

The practical choice. Consistent, convenient, ready to go.

- ✓ Works right out of the can
- ✓ Consistency varies by brand — minimal-ingredient, no-salt-added cans perform best
- ✓ If it seems thin, reduce gently on the stovetop and cool before using
- ✓ Freezes well in ice cube trays



FROM SCRATCH

More concentrated. More protein. More stable foam — but requires intention.

- 1 Soak dried chickpeas overnight in cold water
- 2 Drain, rinse, cover with fresh water
- 3 Simmer low and slow — 1.5 to 2 hours
- 4 Cool in the liquid, then strain
- 5 Result: lightly golden, slightly syrupy

✓ **CONSISTENCY CHECK:** Aquafaba should coat the back of a spoon lightly and feel slightly slippery. If thin, reduce it.

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Getting to stiff peaks.

IDEAL TEMP

70–75°F

1

Clean bowl

Metal or glass, completely dry. Any trace of fat kills the foam — this is non-negotiable.

2

Start on medium

High speed from the start creates large, unstable bubbles. Build structure first.

3

Add cream of tartar

Do this once foam forms but before soft peaks. ⅛ tsp per egg white. Don't skip it.

4

Increase to high

Once soft peaks form. Expect 5-10 min (vs. 3-4 for egg whites). It'll get there.

5

Use immediately

Aquafaba foam weeps and deflates faster than egg whites. Have your next step ready.

6

Don't overwhip

Grainy or broken foam = gone too far. Less margin here than egg whites.

Stiff peaks in aquafaba look slightly less glossy than egg whites and may droop just a little at the tip. That's normal.



No single substitute does all of this.



Bind

Flax egg, chia, silken tofu, banana



Leaven / Lift

Whipped aquafaba, vinegar + baking soda



Foam

Aquafaba — full stop. Nothing else.



Emulsify

Unwhipped aquafaba, silken tofu



Moisture

Applesauce, banana, pumpkin, yogurt



Richness / Fat

Silken tofu + full-fat coconut milk



Protein Set

JUST Egg or silken tofu (quiche, frittata)



Neutral Flavor

Aquafaba, white chia, commercial replacer



Aquafaba is the only substitute that whips — which makes it irreplaceable for meringue-based applications.

Experienced vegan bakers often combine substitutes: aquafaba for lift + flax for binding + vinegar for extra leavening.

WHAT EGGS ACTUALLY DO

Bind 	Leaven / Lift 	Foam 
Emulsify 	Moisture 	Richness / Fat 
Protein Set 	Neutral Flavor 	

No single substitute does all of this.

Quick-reference amounts and best uses.

SUBSTITUTE	AMOUNT	BEST FOR
★ Aquafaba	2 tbsp / egg white · 3 tbsp / whole egg	Meringue, mousse, dacquoise, amaretti, mayo
Flax Egg	1 tbsp ground flax + 3 tbsp water, rest 5-10 min	Dense cookies, brownies, quick breads
Chia Egg	1 tbsp chia + 3 tbsp water, rest 5-10 min	Same as flax; white chia for light batters
Banana / Applesauce	¼ cup per egg	Banana bread, spiced muffins, carrot cake — flavor will show
Silken Tofu	¼ cup blended per egg	Cheesecakes, custards, dense cakes, quiche
Vinegar + Baking Soda	1 tsp baking soda + 1 tbsp vinegar	Lift only — combine with a binding sub
Commercial Replacer	Per package instructions	Cakes and cookies — convenient, consistent
JUST Egg	3 tbsp per egg	Savory: scrambles, frittatas, quiches only

Aquafaba →



Flax Egg ↙



Chia Egg ↘



Silken Tofu ↙



Banana /
Applesauce ↘



Vinegar +
Baking Soda ↙



JUST Egg ↙



Odd, useful, and slightly funny.

It freezes fine.



Freeze in ice cube trays. Thaw as needed. Whips just as well after freezing. No drama.

Bartenders use it.



Craft cocktail bars use it as an egg white sub in sours and fizzes. Works well — and eliminates the raw egg issue entirely.

Humidity is its enemy.



High humidity produces weepier foam and faster collapse. If your meringue is behaving strangely, the weather might be the culprit.

The slightly soapy thing.



Saponins — the same compounds that make canned chickpeas taste off before rinsing — can come through in very delicate preparations. You usually won't notice.

Also: the name was crowdsourced from a Facebook group. The internet giveth.





THE BOTTOM LINE

For most baking, flax egg gets it done.

*Aquafaba earns its place
when you need foam.*

Silken tofu is underrated.

Vinegar + baking soda is a booster, not a standalone.

CHEAT SHEET

Meringue / dacquoise

Aquafaba

Cookie / brownie

Flax egg

Cheesecake / custard

Silken tofu

Lift in cakes

Vinegar + soda

Savory / frittata

JUST Egg

Mayo / emulsion

Aquafaba



Different tools.
Different jobs.
All useful.